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INSTALLER REMINDER

⚡ Tell every customer: PEA power off = On-Grid solar off

Many customers believe "I have solar, so I will still have power in a blackout." If this is not explained on day one, the customer is disappointed and blames the installer when the power goes off.

Why an On-Grid system must switch off

🛡️ **Safety (anti-islanding)**
The inverter must disconnect automatically when PEA power fails, so no power flows back into the lines and endangers PEA staff repairing them. This is a utility requirement.

🔌 **No battery**
An On-Grid system has no storage, so it cannot supply backup power, even in full sun.

What each system does when PEA power is off

System	PEA power off	Best for
☀️ **On-Grid**	**Whole system off**, no backup	Cutting daytime bills
🔋 **Hybrid + battery**	**Power on backup (EPS) circuits only**; grid-side circuits still go off	Lower bills + backup
🏝️ **Off-Grid**	**Power as long as the battery lasts**; not connected to PEA	Sites without grid / independence

What to tell the customer

💬 "The On-Grid system **stops immediately when PEA power goes off**, for the safety of PEA staff. To have power during a blackout you need a **hybrid system with a battery**, and the important appliances must be connected to the **backup circuit**."

Checklist before handover

- [ ] Explain whether the system is On-Grid, Hybrid or Off-Grid, and what goes off when PEA power fails.
- [ ] Hybrid: ask which appliances must work in a blackout (water pump, fridge, lights, router, etc.).
- [ ] Connect those appliances to the **backup (EPS) circuit**, never ahead of the MDB or on the grid side.
- [ ] Label the distribution board: which circuits have backup and which go off.
- [ ] Switch off PEA power in front of the customer and show what still works.
- [ ] Have the customer sign that they understand, on the handover form.

⚠️ Real case: a water pump was wired ahead of the MDB, so it was not on the backup circuit. During a PEA outage the house had battery power but no water, and the customer thought the solar system had failed.

Reference: PEA Grid Code for connecting generating systems, www.pea.co.th

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